

116 Easily confused phrases

In English, there are several phrases which sound or look similar, but have different meanings. It is important not to get these confused.

See also:

Present simple **1** Present continuous **4**

"Used to" and "would" **15**

116.1 "GET USED TO" AND "BE USED TO"

To **"get used to (doing)"** something describes the process of adapting to new or different situations until they become familiar or normal.

Waking up early for my new job was difficult at first, but eventually I **got used to** it.



To **"be used to (doing)"** something means that something has been done for long enough that it is normal and familiar.

I've lived in the city for years, so I **am used to** the bad pollution.



TIP

These phrases should not be confused with "used to" (without "be" or "get"), which is used when talking about a regular past action.

FURTHER EXAMPLES



When I travel, I **get used to** different customs very quickly.

[I find it easy to adapt to different customs when I travel.]



I **got used to** the cold weather within a couple of weeks.

[I adapted to the cold weather within two weeks.]



I **am used to** spicy food as I've always eaten it.

[I am accustomed to eating spicy food.]



We **were used to** the old teacher, so it was a shame when she left.

[We were accustomed to our previous teacher, but then she left.]